

ANCIENT INDIAN HISTORY

FROM CONCEPT TO FACT



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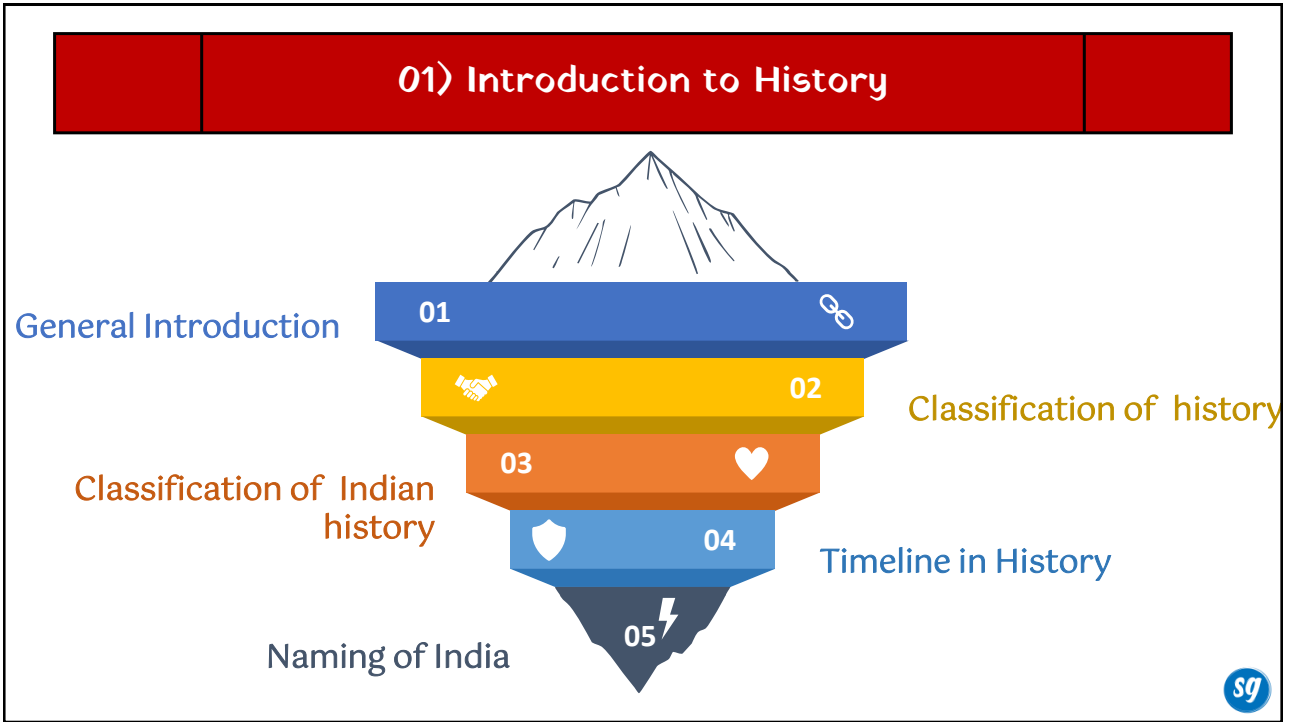
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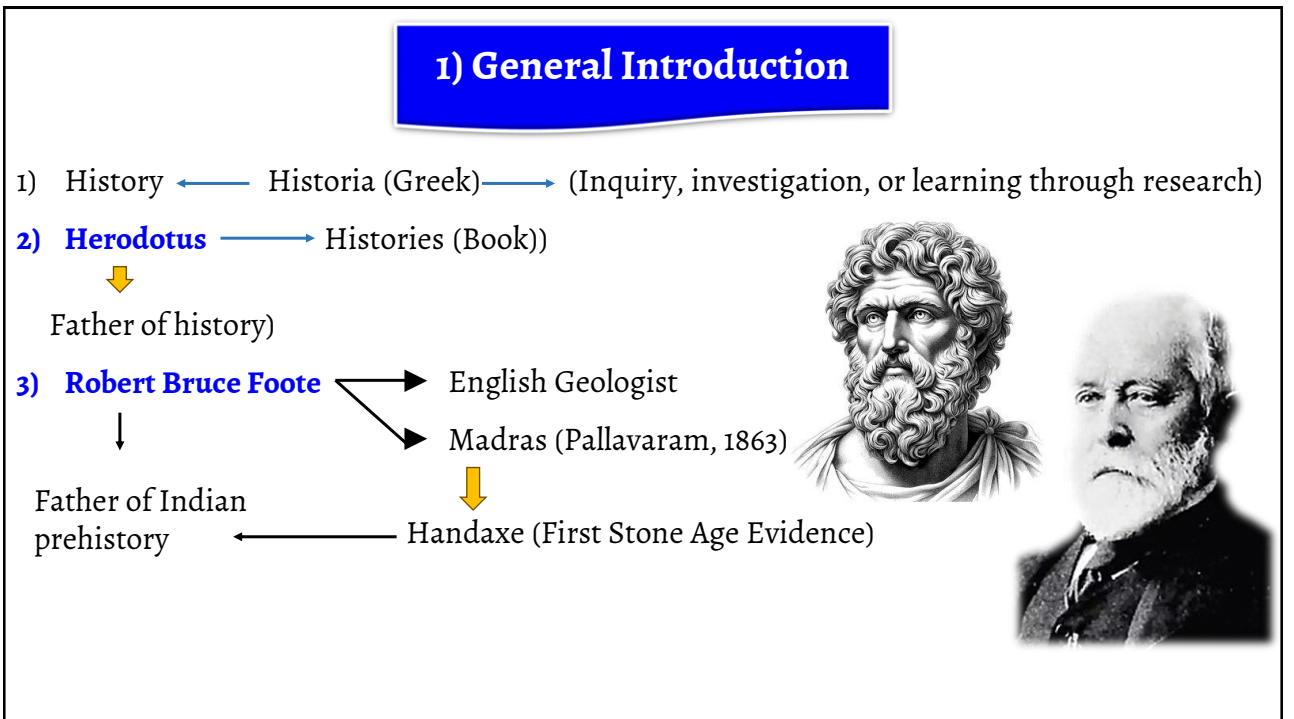
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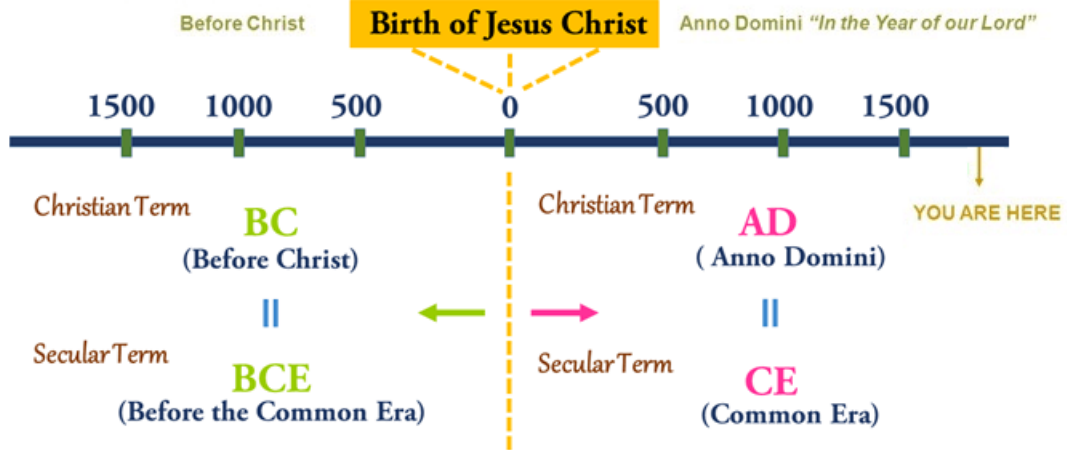
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2) Timeline in History

BC/AD or BCE/CE (Historical Terms)



5

3) Classification of history

Pre-Historic Period : It is the period of human culture for which no written records are available. The history of this period is studied by archaeological evidences only. This period is divided into three parts viz. Palaeolithic Age, Mesolithic Age and Neolithic Age.



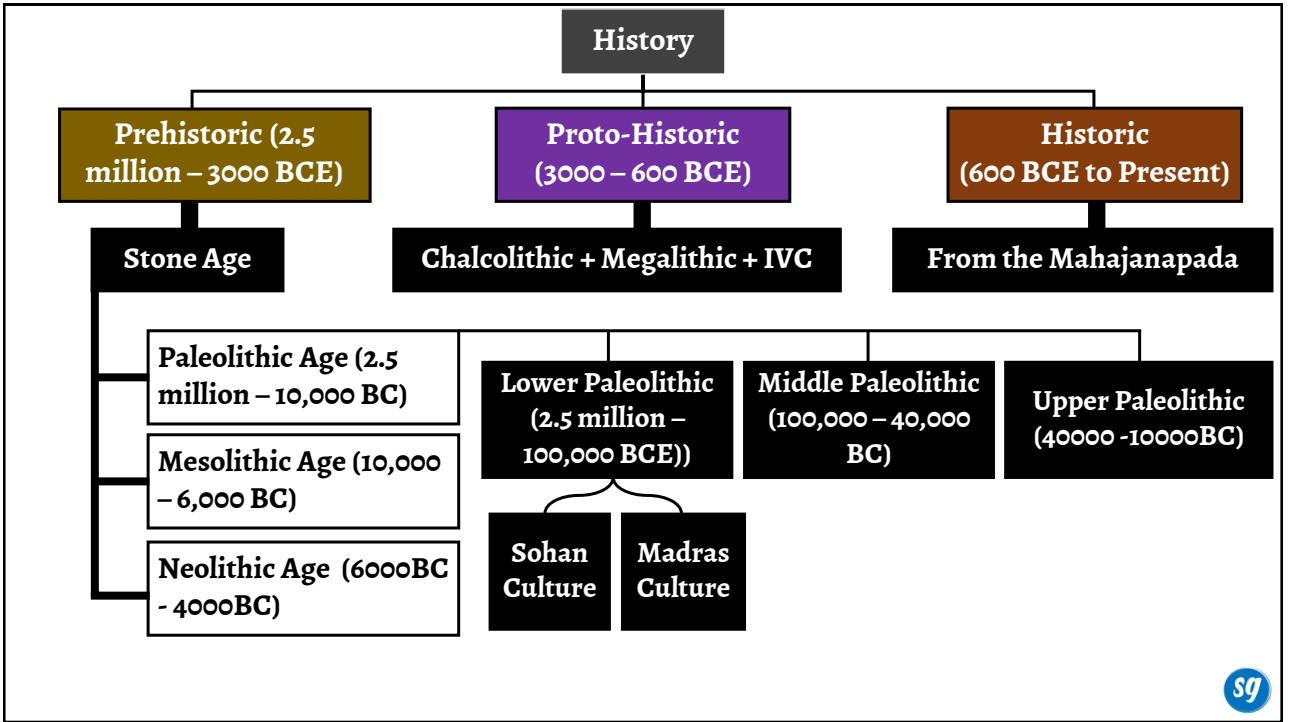
Proto-history Period : Protohistory is the period between prehistoric and modern history. Protohistoric period has a record of writings but it is not understood by the succeeding ages. Duration of this period is 2500 BC to 600 BC.



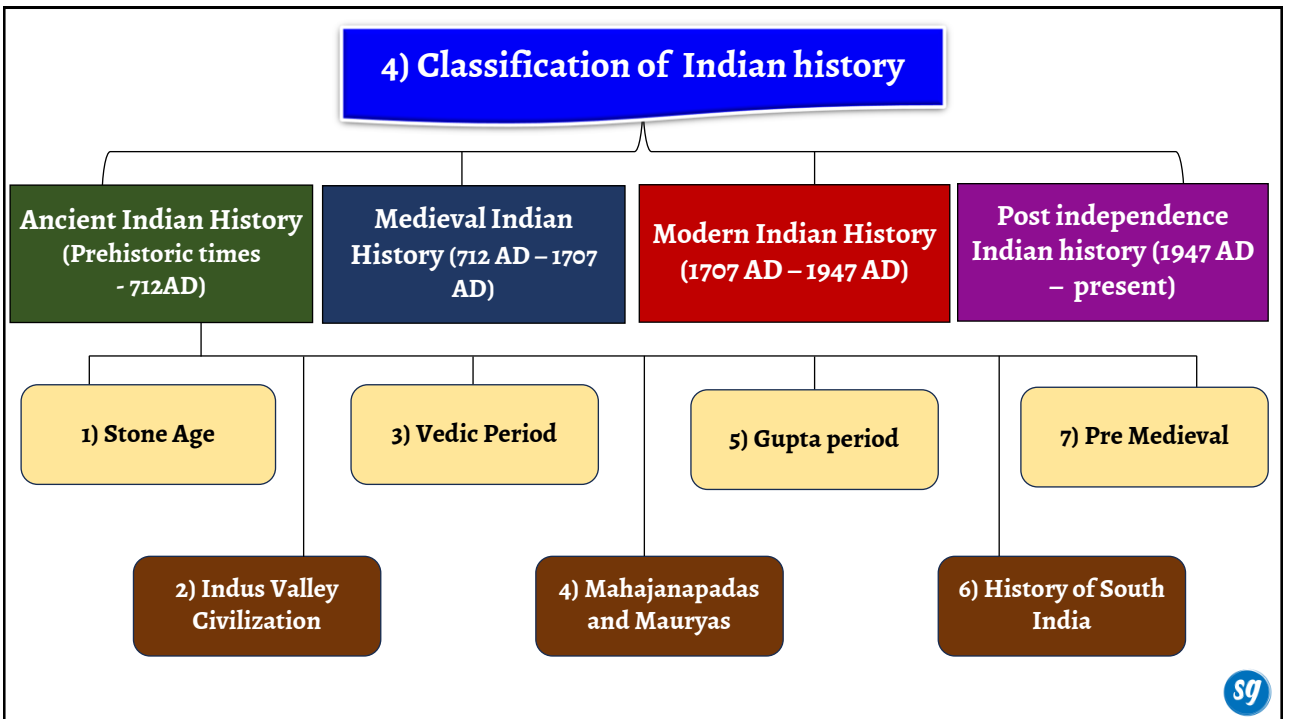
Historical Period : It is the period whose information is available in written records. Historical activities after 600 BC included in this period.



6



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5) Naming of India

1) Bharat

- ☀ **Rigveda** —————→ The Bharata clan)
- ☀ Epics and Puranas —————→ Bharatvarsha
- ☀ India is a part of a huge landmass – **Jambudvīpa**

2) India

- ☀ **Greeks** —————→ India (Indus River called Inde)

3) Hindustan

- ☀ Persian historian Minhaj-i-Siraj

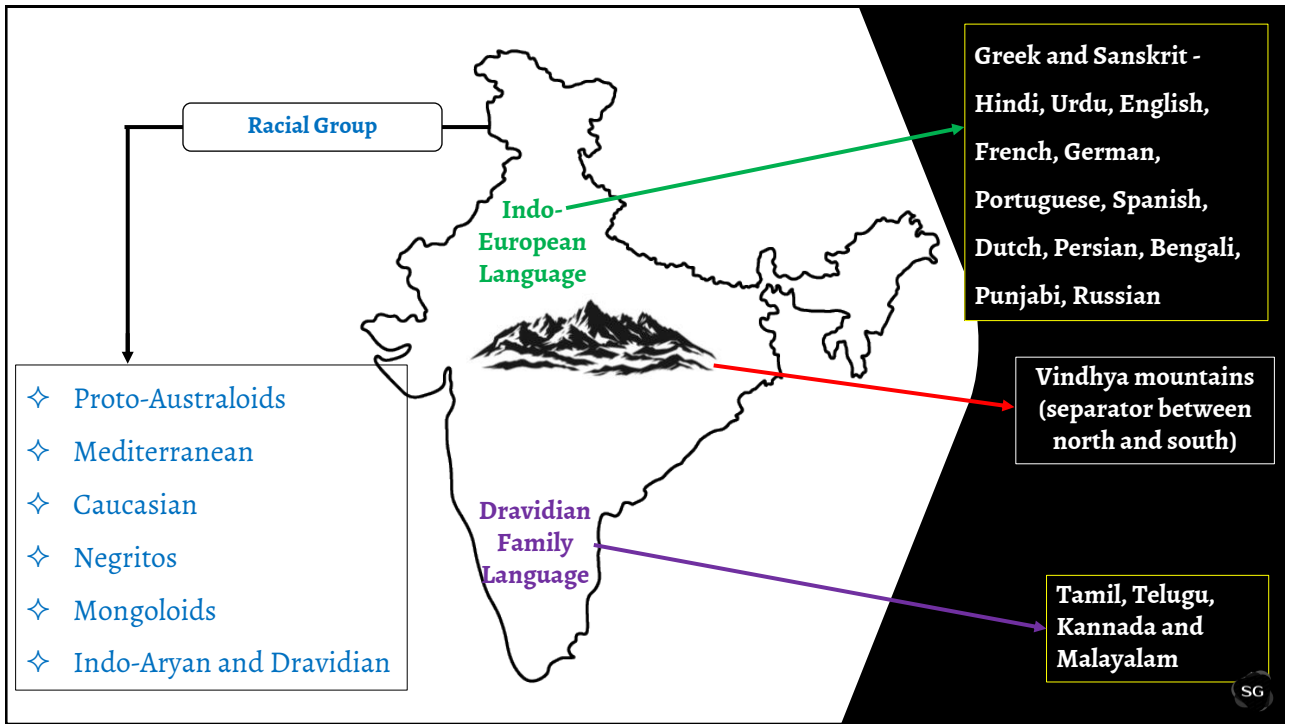


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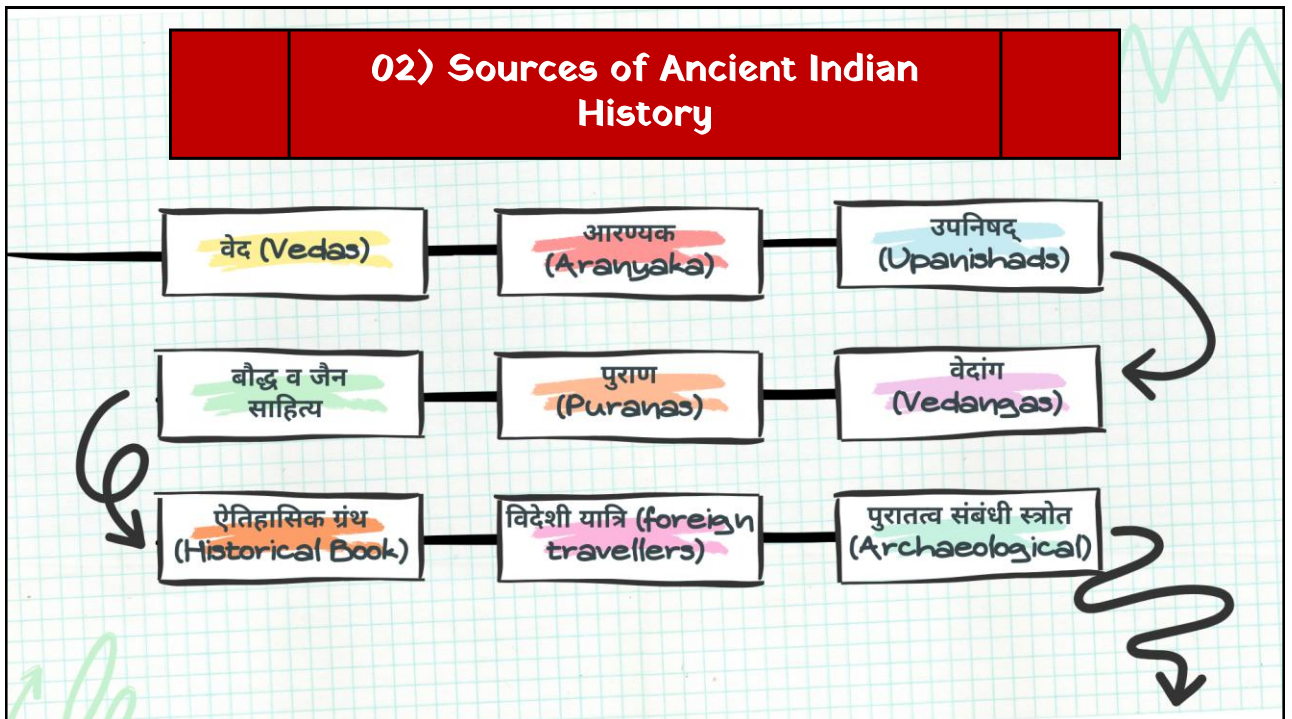
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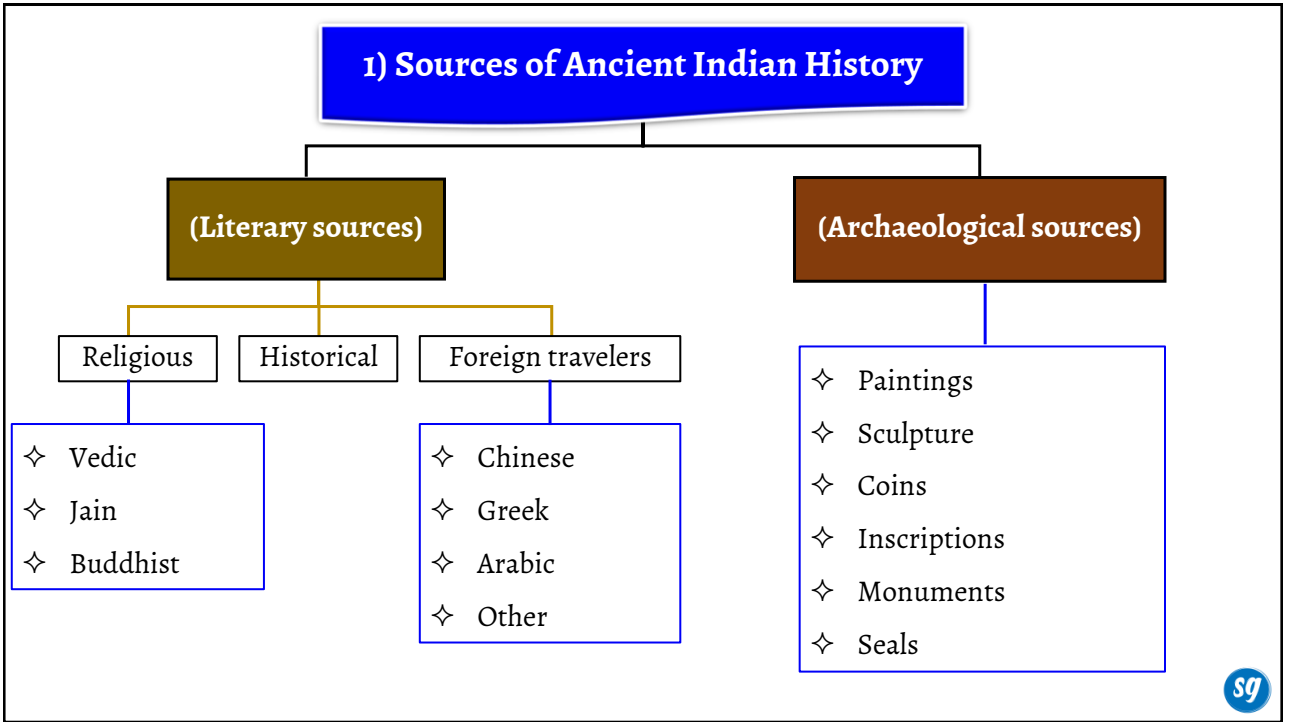
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1.1) Vedas

1) India's oldest religious text

2) Vedas

- Apaurusheya
- Shruti
- Nitya
- Compiler) - Krishna Dwaipayana Vedavyasa

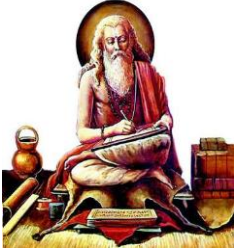
3) Vedic Literature :-

- Samhita
- Brahmin
- Aranyaka
- Upanishad

5) Number - 04

- Rigveda
- Samaveda
- Yajurveda
- Atharvaveda

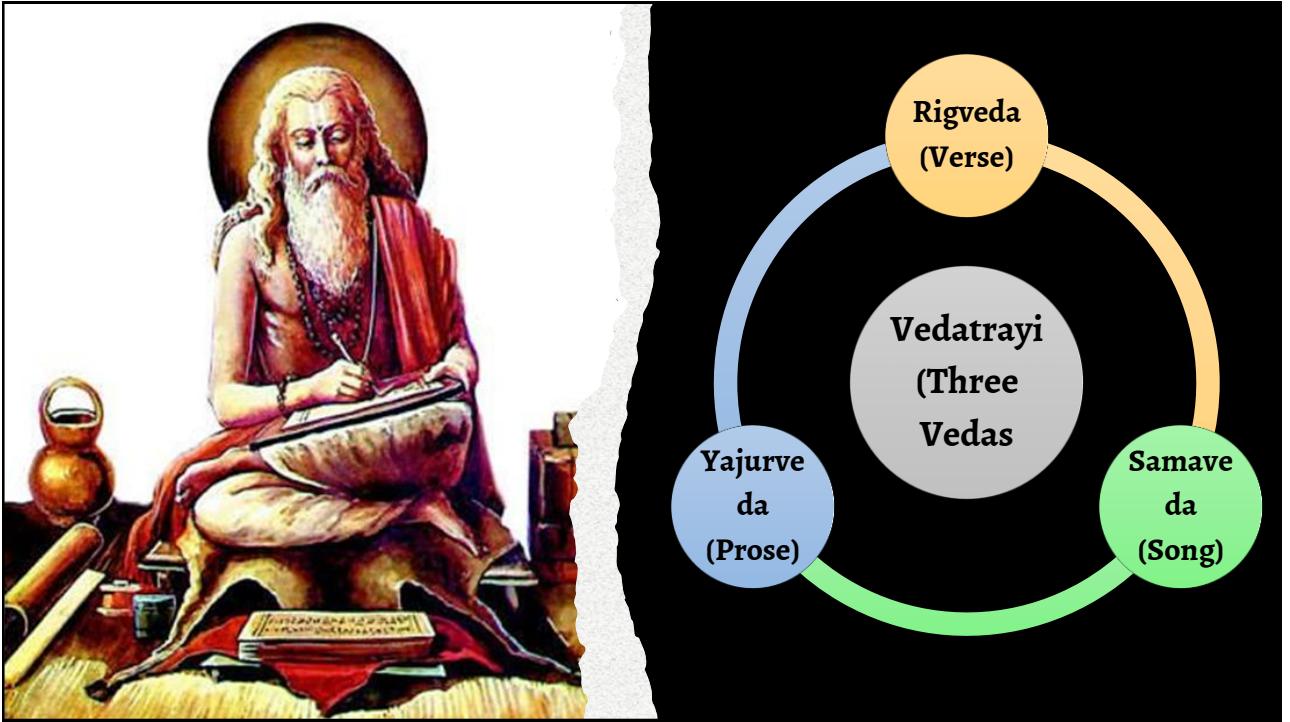
6) Language :- Vedic Sanskrit (Script - Brahmi)




Vedatrayi



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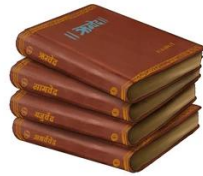
16

A) Rigveda

1) The oldest Vedas

2) Classification :-

- ✧ 10 Mandalas
- ✧ 85 Anuvakas
- ✧ 1028 Suktas
- ✧ 10552 Richas



3) Information :-

- ✧ 2 to 7 are the oldest
- ✧ Life of Aryans and Sapta Sindhu region

✧ God and ancient religious beliefs

4) Reciter of Rigveda :- Hotri

✧ Four Ritvij - Hota, Udgata, Adhvaryu and Brahma

5) Other :-

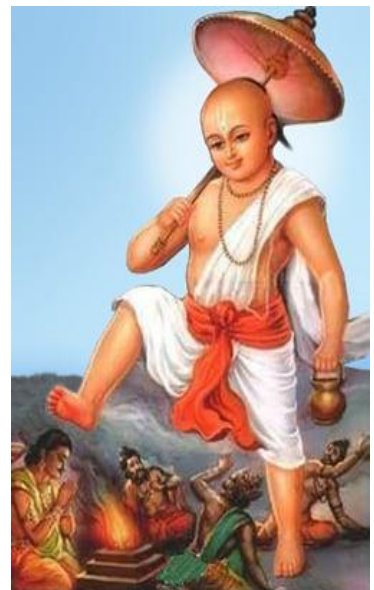
- ✧ Branches :- Shakal, Bashkal, Ashwalayan, Shankhayan, Mandukey)
- ✧ Cow is called "Aghanya"
- ✧ Mention of Brahma
- ✧ No mention of soul
- ✧ Vamana Avatar



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भगवान विष्णु के दस अवतार



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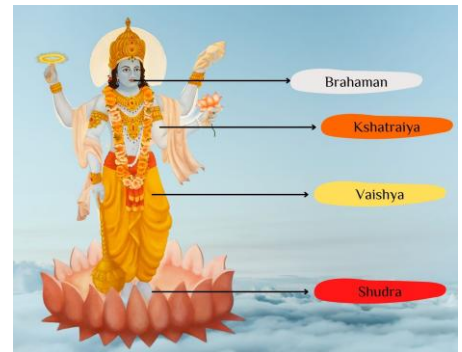
A.1) Major Mandals of Rigveda

Mandala	Rishi (Sage)	Information
III	Vishwamitra	✧ Gayatri Mantra - Addressed to Goddess Savitri ✧ Vishwamitra - River Dialogue (Beas and Sutlej Rivers)
VII	Vasishtha	✧ Battle of Ten Kings
VIII	Kanva-Angiras	✧ Handwritten Richa – Khil
IX	Many Sages	✧ Dedicated to the god Soma
X	Many Sages	✧ First mention of four Varna system in Purusha Sukta ✧ Chaturvarna System - Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, and Shudra

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10. Many sages

- ✧ The sages of this mandal are called Mahasukta
- ✧ This is the **latest mandal** among all the mandalas of Rigveda
- ✧ Monism, polytheism and pantheism were discussed in it
- ✧ Mention of **Purusha Sukta** and the **Varna system** emerged through it
 - ✧ From the mouth of Brahma – Brahmin
 - ✧ Kshatriya by the arm
 - ✧ Vaishya from thigh
 - ✧ Shudras originated from the feet
- ✧ **Vasudev Kutumbaka**,
- ✧ Marriage Sukta,
- ✧ **Nasadiya Sukta** (mystery of creation),
- ✧ **River Sukta** (description of 21 rivers),



sg

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A.2) Major rivers of Rigveda

Major rivers :-

- ✧ Sindhu (Most mentioned) → Hiranya
- ✧ Saraswati (Most sacred) → Matetama, Devitama, Naditama
- ✧ Yamuna → 3 times
- ✧ Ganga → 1 time
- ✧ Marudvridha River - A river flowing in Kashmir Valley



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1) Brahmana Texts	Aitareya (Author - Mahidas)	- Rules of Royal Consecration - The king was called Vishvamatta and Dharmasya-gopta - Rules of coronation
	Kaushitaki (Author - Kaushitaki)	- Wealth, Woman, and Land as main causes of conflict - Money, wife and land were main reasons for conflict.
2) Aranyakas	Aitareya	
	Shankhayan	
3) Upanishad (Vedanta)	Aitareya	- Number of Upanishads in Rigveda is 10 - It mentions the importance of Om (ॐ)
	Kaushitaki	Description of the nature of Prana-tattva (Brahman) as symbol of Atman
4) Upaveda	Ayurveda	



22

B) Yajurveda

1) Yajurveda ← “Yaju”



(Sacrifice and yajna)

2) **Subject**:- Compilation of rules, rituals and procedures of Yajnas

3) Reciter :- **Adhvryu**

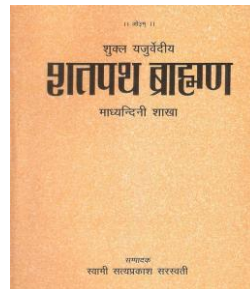
4) The only Veda that :- **Prose and verse**

- ✧ Rigveda, Samaveda and Atharvaveda - only verses

5) Brahmin texts :- **Shatapatha Brahmana**

8) **Shatapatha Brahmana** :-

- ✧ Small Veda
- ✧ Oldest Brahmin text - composed after Rigveda
- ✧ Purukha - Urvashi



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Yajurveda

Shukla Yajurveda
(Verse)

Other Name – Vajasaneyi Samhita

(Madhyandin)

(Kanva)

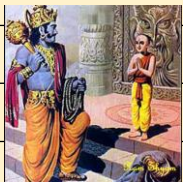
Krishna Yajurveda
(Prose)

- 1) Kaṭha
- 2) Maitrayani
- 3) Kapiṣṭhala
- 4) Taittirīya

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1) Brahmin texts	Shatapatha (Shukla Yajurveda - Maharishi Yajnavalkya)	○ The largest, most authentic and ancient Brahmin text ○ In this, woman has been called Ardhangini
	Taittiriya (Krishna Yajurveda - Rishi Tittir)	○ Three rin (Dev rin, Pitra rin and Rishi rin) ○ Pancha Mahayagya (Brahma-yagya, Pitra-yagya, Deva-yagya, Bhuta-yagya and Manushya-yagya)
2) Aranyaka	Brihadaranyaka (Shukla)	
	Shatapatha (Shukla)	
	Taittireeya (Krishna)	
	Maitrayani (Krishna)	
3) Upvedas	Dhanurveda	○ Written by - Bhrigu or Vishwamitra or Bharadwaja
○ Major Upanishads of Shukla Yajurveda (total 19):- Brihadaranyaka and Isha Upanishad ○ Major Upanishads of Krishna Yajurveda (total 32) :- Taittiriya, Maitrayani, Kath and Shwetashvara.		

4) Upanishads (Vedanta)	Brihadaranyaka	○ Creator - Maharishi Yajnavalkya ○ Yajnavalkya - Gargi Dialogue ○ Katyayani Dialogue
	Isha Upanishad	○ Spiritual themes ○ It is the second smallest upanishad after the Mandukya Upanishad.
	Taittireeya	○ The dialogue between father Varuna and Bhrigu
	Maitrayani	○ The newest Upanishad
	Katha Upanishad	○ The dialogue between Nachiketa and Yama
	Shvetashvara	○ Meaning - Carried by a white horse ○ First mention of the word bhakti - Guru Bhakti and Navdha Bhakti



C) Samaveda

1) **The literal meaning of "Sama"** - Singing

- **Shortest of all veda**
- Musical chants sung during yajnas
- The oldest book related to Indian music

2) Reciter :- **Udgata**

3) Compiler - **Jaimini and Sukarma**

4) Number of Mantras - 27 chapters and 1875 (excluding 75 from Rigveda)

5) **Lord Krishna** - "I am Samveda among the Vedas, Indra among the gods, mind among the senses and consciousness power of living beings."

6) **Branches:-** 3 (Originally – 1000)

- Kauthuma Samhita - Most prevalent - North India
- Ranayaniya Samhita
- Jaiminiya Samhita (Talavakara Samhita) - South India



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1) Brahmin texts (Number-8)	Panchavish / Tandaya / Mahabrahman	○ Acharya Tandaya - The biggest Brahmin text after Shatpath Brahmin ○ Topic - Somayagya + Indra as the originator of castes
	Shadvish	○ Famine, earthquake and witchcraft
	Jaiminiya	○ Author - Jaimini, disciple of Vedvyas and Talwakar, disciple of Jaimini
2) Aranyaka	Chandogya	○ It is related to Tandy Brahmana
	Jaiminiya	○ Mention of Om and Gayatri
3) Upanishads (number-16)	Kena Upanishad	○ In this, the mystical nature of Brahma is discussed. ○ The story of Uma Devi and Hemvati
	Chandogya Upanishad	○ The oldest Upanishad (Along with Brihadaranyaka) ○ Mentions Krishna, the son of Devaki, for the first time ○ Three ashrams (Brahmacharya, Gr̥hastha & Vanaprastha), Shwetaketu dialogue, account of Narad Sanatkumar, story of Indra Virochana, story of Satyakam Jabali,
4) Upvedas	Gandharva Veda	○ Parent - Indra / Narada / Bharat Muni {Subject - Art and Music}

sq

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D) Atharvaveda

1) The latest Vedas

2) **Compiler :-** Rishi Atharva and Rishi Angira

3) **Other Names :-** Atharvangiroveda, Shresthaveda, Brahmaveda, Bhisagveda, Chhandaveda and Kshatraveda.

4) **Texter :-** Brahma

5) **Prithvi Sukta :** Earth is my mother, I am her son

6) **Subject matter :-** Magic, Tantra-Mantra, Surgery, Medicine and secular life

✧ **20 Kandas (Chapters)** + 730 Suktas + 5987 Mantras

✧ Sabha and Samiti - **Two daughters of Prajapati**

7) **Branches**

- Shaunakiya (Shaunaka)
- Paippaladi (Pippalada)

7) **Mention of Magadha and Anga**

8) Kuru Dynasty Ruler - **Parikshit**



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1) Brahmin texts (8)	Gopath Brahmin	○ Creator :- Rishi Gopath ○ Omkar + concept of Kaivalya + branch :- Pippalad + origin of the universe
2) Upanishads	Mundak Upanishad	○ Satyameva Jayate
	Mandukya Upanishad	○ It is the shortest Upanishad
	Prashna Upanishad	○ It is mentioned in this that the Sun gives life force to the entire world
3) Upvedas	Shilpaveda	○ Creator - Vishwakarma {Subject - Architecture}

SG

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Veda	Brahmin texts	Upanishads	Aranyaka	Sukta	Reciter	Upvedas
Rigveda	○ Aitereya (Panchika) ○ Koshatak	○ Aitereya ○ Kaushtaki	○ Aitereya ○ Kaushtaki ○ Shankhayan a	○ 1028 Sukta ○ 10552 Verses	Hotri	Ayurveda
Yajurveda	○ Shatpath (Shukla) ○ Taittiriya	○ Brihadaranyaka ○ (Shukla) Ish (Shukla) ○ Maitrayani ○ Taittiriya, Kath ○ Shwetashwar	○ Taittiriya ○ Brihadaran yaka ○ Shatapath Maitrayani		Adhvaryu	Dhanurveda
Samveda	○ Panchavish ○ Jaiminiya	○ chhandogya ○ ken	○ jaimini ○ chhandogya	1875 mantra	Udgata	Gandharvaveda (written by Narada)
Atharvaveda	○ Gopath	○ Question Mundak ○ Mandukya	○ There is no Aranyaka	5849 mantra	Brahma	Shilpveda (Vishwakarma)

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1.2) Brahmin texts

- 1) The texts that expound **about sacrifices (yajnas)**
 - Subject - Procedures of **sacrificial rituals**
- 2) Aitareya Brahmana - **Shunah Shesha dialogue**
- 3) Shadvinsha Brahmana - **Contains the narrative of Indra and Ahalya**
- 4) Shatapatha Brahmana - Upanayana ceremony, the story of King Dushyanta, and the tale of the Ashwini Kumars granting youth to sage Chyavana.)



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1.3) Aranyaka

- 1) **Aranyaka :-** Aranya (forest) + Yak (knowledge)
- 2) These contain the esoteric and mystical meanings of mantras
- 3) These are also called mystery texts or secret scriptures
- 4) Sacred thread (Yajnopavita) reference - Taittiriya Aranyaka



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1.4) Upanishads

- 1) **Vedanta :** The last parts of the Vedic literature
- 2) **The literal meaning of Upanishad is :-**
 - ϕ Upa - near
 - ϕ Ni - devotedly
 - ϕ Shad - to sit

} Sitting in devotion near the Guru
- 3) It is related to **philosophy, metaphysics, spirituality, soul, god and salvation.**

○ **Number of Upanishads: - 108 Upanishads** are mentioned in **Muktikopanishad**



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